

Wildfire smoke

ACTION CHECKLIST

For smoke without an immediate fire threat, stay indoors with windows and doors closed, use filtered recirculated air or a portable air cleaner, and check local air-quality updates. If ordered to evacuate, leave promptly. Severe breathing difficulty requires emergency medical help.

[] Know which problem you face

Check official fire, evacuation, and air-quality notices for your address. An evacuation order changes the decision immediately.

[] If leaving, leave early

Take people, pets, medication, keys, and essentials; tell a contact where you are going. Use the evacuation guide and current route instructions.

[] If sheltering from smoke

Close windows and doors. Set HVAC to recirculate where possible, use a portable air cleaner or a cleaner indoor room, and avoid adding indoor smoke from candles, frying, or smoking.

[] Limit outside exposure

If you must go outside in smoke, a well-fitting N95 or P100 respirator can reduce particle exposure; ordinary cloth masks do not provide the same protection.

WATCH FOR

If fire threatens the building or officials order departure, indoor smoke control is no substitute for evacuation. If breathing becomes difficult or symptoms are severe, seek urgent medical help.

Updated 2026-10-02 | General guidance. Follow current local instructions. In immediate danger, contact emergency services.

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/wildfire-smoke/>

Wildfire · official guidance